

Dating

Dating is when a person spends time with someone who they're romantically or sexually interested in. Different people are ready for dating at different times of their lives, and some people never want to go on a date at all.

Why people date

People date for lots of reasons. They may be attracted to the person that they're dating, they might really enjoy talking to them, or they may simply find dating fun. Many people go on dates because they want to be in a long-term relationship, and dating is a way to find out more about a person and whether they are compatible.

Some people go on dates because they think that they should be, and not because they want to. Others date because they feel lonely or because someone popular asks them out. These are bad reasons for dating, and are unfair to the other person.



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TEEN HINTS

Peer pressure

Different people feel ready to date at different times. Sometimes, teens get pressured into dating, even when they don't really want to or don't think it's a good idea. It's important only to date when you feel ready, and when it is with somebody you are genuinely interested in.

Types of date

People date in many different ways. There's no right or wrong way to date, as long as everyone is enjoying themselves and being honest.



Paired dating

When two people are romantically or sexually interested in each other, they often like to spend time together, alone. On these dates, both know that they are more than friends. The date is a time when they can have personal conversations, and be physically intimate if that's what they both want.

Group dating

Many teens find that group dating is a fun way to spend time with their "date" without the pressure of being one-on-one. In a group date, two people in the group are romantically or sexually interested in each other and are spending time together within a group of other friends.

Cross-cultural

Individuals in cross-cultural or cross-religious relationships need to be open-minded and accepting. Some experience pressure from their families to break up due to worry over the compromises that they might need to make in their own culture or religion to accommodate their partner's beliefs.